Rep. Tom Emmer on The Fox News Rundown

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NARRATOR:

In many places, affordability is a key issue as many Americans try to make ends meet. But in Minnesota, this voter says there are other major concerns.

VOTER:

It's crime and fraud. I mean, fraud is a crime and it needs to be addressed. And it hasn't been for 16 years, maybe. We've had a lot of the same people in office and I think people are just done.

NARRATOR:

As voters in Minnesota and across the country are casting their ballots ahead of next week's midterms.

MIKE:

The work has been done, but you got to run it right through the tape, Mike. House Majority Whip and Minnesota Congressman Tom Emmer. Why don't I set it up this way so I can tell you what we're looking at?

REP. TOM EMMER:

Go back to 2018, Mike. In 2018, Republicans in the House lost 40 seats. it looked like a bloodbath. But in reality, if you counted the cumulative vote total from coast to coast between what would have kept Republicans in the majority, the difference between being in the majority and losing 40 seats, it was only about 120,000 cumulative votes. The idea that you can't win a midterm is ridiculous. One party, as you know, controlled the U.S. House of Representatives for almost a half century, not too long ago. And I just told you how close it was in Trump's first midterm. The key is this. It is a turnout election. I know a lot of people talk about the contrast between common sense and crazy. For us, it really is about getting our people out to vote, Mike, whether you bank your vote early or you're voting on election day. If our people show up, we're going to be just fine.

MIKE:

So if you're watching news coverage these days or listening to it or reading it online, there's all kinds of issues out there. I'm curious, though, when you're talking with voters, what is the single biggest issue voters are telling you that's driving them to the ballot box?

REP. TOM EMMER:

Well, it's definitely an economic issue in most places. The war, it's important. The people that you talk to when you start having the conversations recognize that the extreme radical folks running around can't have a nuclear weapon. there's a wide variety of things in terms of what people look at but when you go out and you talk to them our people are energized mike they're energized because we have done what we were hired to do the border is sealed i was down there a couple weeks ago with a bunch of our candidates there's nobody coming

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across the border the way it was under the biden administration in fact the border is more sealed than ever people do want to talk about the economy because what democrats have effectively done with their left-wing media is try to focus on just a couple of things in the mix, which are important. Look, $4 gas and $6 diesel is entirely unacceptable. And Republicans and Donald Trump are doing everything we can to deal with it. The price of gas, though, Mike, is still a dollar or more lower than it was at the worst under Biden. And that wasn't because of a war or a mission where you're trying to stop the proliferation of nuclear weapons. And look, we've got to talk more about personal income has never been higher in the history of this country. Poverty has never been lower in the history of this country. You've got to talk to the people who got the benefit of the big, beautiful bill with no taxes on tips, no taxes on overtime, the more money, Social Security money in the pockets of seniors. A lot of good stuff to talk about.

MIKE:

Some folks I respect say that you are a likely future speaker of the House of Representatives. At election time, a lot of times people think about what the future may hold. What are your thoughts on your political future personally?

REP. TOM EMMER:

I will tell you what, Mike, people can think about their future all they want. All Tom Emmer thinks about is winning. You talk to those same people that you respect, and they'll tell you that I am designed as a team guy that takes care of everybody on my team. And I'm joking, but it's probably true. If you're on my team, you may not love me, but you're going to like the fact that I'm on your team. If you're not on my team, you probably don't like me very much because I am built to make sure that we succeed. Donald Trump was elected by 77 million Americans with a mission. That mission was to put Americans and this country first and to make markets available to all of our people as opposed to having others having the U.S. market available to them without the reciprocity. That's what this is all about is finishing that agenda. So my focus is going to be exactly that. And then I made it very clear. I expect we are going to be in the majority. And Mike Johnson will continue to be the speaker. Steve Scalise is our leader. I'm going to ask for the privilege and the honor to continue working for our members as the the whip in the U.S. House of Representatives. But right now, this is about you're in the red zone, Mike. We've got football. Everybody knows what the red zone is. We're we're inside the 20. Now we've got to punch it into the end zone. And then we can move forward and finish this agenda that Donald Trump promised the American people.

MIKE:

Fair enough. Let's turn to your home state of Minnesota. The state's fraud scandals have become a major issue in this election. What do you think voters want to see happen next?

REP. TOM EMMER:

Minnesota, number one issue is fraud. And I think Minnesotans are sick and tired of dealing with this incompetence. And in some cases, it appears to be corrupt leadership from Tim Walls and Keith Ellison at all. I mean, Tim Walls is the absolute worst governor in the country. He was not going to be able to run again because of this fraud. Amy Klobuchar is running. Amy's got a tough brand. She's built this over many, many years of being not too hot, not too cold, working on both sides of the aisle. That's a tough brand to go after in Minnesota. but Lisa Damuth, the Speaker of the House is giving her an absolute run for her money and based on this fraud issue what's going to change with Democrats remaining in office? The other offices, Keith Ellison I think Ron Schutz is going to beat him Too many Minnesotans know who Keith Ellison is and they know that he's the guy on a 54 minute tape promising Somali fraudsters that he will protect them from an investigation that

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they're complaining about I think Minnesotans have had enough of that and Michelle Tafoi is the other one You better watch. You may pick up a Senate seat in Minnesota because you got Peggy Flanagan, who's up to her eyeballs in the same fraud issues that Tim Walls was was saddled with. She just happens to be the lieutenant governor instead of the top guy. But look, there are photographs of her with a friend of hers for 25 years, putting on a hijab, dancing around after some election a year ago. that person had it was stripped of her ability to uh to deal in medicaid because she's under investigation for fraud they're all right in the middle of it and i think michelle tafoya may be the next u.s senator from the state of minnesota again if our people show up

NARRATOR:

minnesota recently created a new office of the inspector general to help prevent fraud but a senate candidate says the law still has significant gaps what more needs to be done to catch fraud before taxpayer money goes missing.

REP. TOM EMMER:

Nonsense. It's just total nonsense. And once again, it's nothing more than window dressing that's trying to cover up the corruption that we have in Minnesota. Think about this. The Medicaid housing program that I told you about, I think it was created back in 2022. They estimated that it was going to cost about $2 million a year. They shut it down a year ago after they had built almost a half a billion dollars. like 450 some million was built out of that program in just a few years and then they create this inspector general after come on mike uh we're smarter than that this really you don't need new laws what you need is people to do their job conduct the oversight and by the way if they were involved if they were looking the other way at the very least they should be fired if not ultimately prosecuted. And I think that's really what you're looking at. This is what Democrats do all the time. They're ripping us off. And so they create another office to tell us, oh, now we're going to do our job. And we were missing this person. No, you weren't. You've got all the authority that you need. Do your job. And when you don't do your job, let's make sure someone's held accountable. That's what's going on here.

MIKE:

Your fellow Minnesotan Congresswoman Ilhan Omar is facing a federal investigation into her immigration history and recent court filing has raised questions about her name. She denies any wrongdoing. What do you make of this investigation and what answers do you think Minnesota voters need to know?

REP. TOM EMMER:

First, let's make it clear because we're in the election season and I noticed that aside from your colleagues at Fox, I don't see anybody reporting clearly. The investigation on Ilhan Omar was started under the biden department of justice this has been out there for a while remember this is a gal that there have been allegations for years that she committed immigration fraud with her brother that her father illegally gained access into this country by lying about his relationship to the burmese military and human atrocities that he committed that he changed his name in order to to gain admittance and that his children all have that false name. There's also been a recently, you've noticed it's about her birthday. When her father, who was illegally admitted into the country, was naturalized, all the children that are under the age of 18 are automatically naturalized with the parent. If you're 18 or older, you have to apply separately. In this case, Ms. Omar listed her birth date or her father did as 17 years and 10 months. And I'm not going to be surprised as this thing gets more clear that she was over the age of 18, in which they say there's an administrative procedure. She should not be a U.S. citizen. How poetic would that justice be? We'll see, Mike, but Minnesotans have had enough. This has been out there for a long time. And again, the press wants to look the other way because the problem is in Minnesota, everybody's afraid of being called a racist, a xenophobe, and Ilhan plays the greatest victim that ever lived on

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earth. In this case, I think it finally caught up with her because we're not talking about her religion. We're not talking about the color of her skin or anything other than the fact that if she is a criminal, she is going to be identified as a criminal and maybe for once will be held accountable.

MIKE:

We will follow that. House Majority Whip Tom Emmer, the great state of Minnesota. Grateful for your time, sir. Safe travels on the campaign trail.

REP. TOM EMMER:

Thank you, Mike.

NARRATOR:

We thank Whip Emmer for joining us today and to hear even more exclusive analysis of the key races in Minnesota and Texas. Listen to the Fox News Rundown Evening Edition.

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